

Refund, Return & Exchange Policy

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1. Introduction & Scope

Acme Commerce Inc. (“Acme”, “we”, “us”, or “our”) is committed to delivering high-quality products and an exceptional customer experience. This Refund, Return & Exchange Policy (“Policy”) governs all returns, refunds, exchanges, and store-credit requests for products purchased directly from Acme through our website (acme-commerce.example), mobile application, or authorized sales channels. It applies to retail customers in all supported regions unless local law provides stronger consumer rights, in which case local law prevails.

By placing an order with Acme, you acknowledge that you have read, understood, and agreed to this Policy. This Policy is incorporated by reference into our Terms of Service.

2. Definitions

Term	Meaning
Delivery Date	The date the carrier marks the parcel as delivered at the shipping address.
Return Window	The period during which an eligible item may be returned, starting on the Delivery Date.
Original Condition	Unused, undamaged, with all tags, manuals, accessories, and packaging intact.
Final Sale	Items explicitly marked as non-returnable at time of purchase.
Store Credit	A non-transferable credit applied to your Acme account for future purchases.
RMA	Return Merchandise Authorization — the unique number issued when you start a return.

3. Return Window & Eligibility

Unless otherwise stated on the product page at the time of purchase, the standard return window is **30 calendar days** from the Delivery Date. Certain categories and promotional periods carry different windows, summarized below:

Category / Scenario	Return Window	Notes
Standard merchandise	30 days	From Delivery Date

Category / Scenario	Return Window	Notes
Electronics & accessories	15 days	Sealed packaging required
Apparel & footwear	30 days	Tags attached, unworn
Holiday purchases (Nov 15 – Dec 24)	Until Jan 31	Extended holiday window
Marketplace / third-party seller	14–30 days	Seller policy governs
Custom / engraved items	Non-returnable	Unless defective
Clearance (≥ 40% off)	Final Sale	Non-returnable

4. Non-Returnable Items

The following items are **not eligible** for return or refund unless they arrive damaged, defective, or materially different from the product description:

- Gift cards, e-gift cards, and promotional vouchers.
- Downloadable software, digital licenses, and activation keys (once revealed).
- Perishable goods, food, beverages, and consumables.
- Intimate apparel, swimwear, and pierced jewelry (hygiene reasons).
- Hazardous materials, flammable liquids, and lithium batteries (shipping restrictions).
- Personalized, monogrammed, or custom-made products.
- Items marked “Final Sale,” “Clearance,” or “Non-Returnable” on the product page.
- Products returned more than 30 days after the Delivery Date without prior authorization.
- Any item missing its serial number, UPC, or original packaging.

5. Condition Requirements

To qualify for a full refund, returned items must be in Original Condition. This means:

- The item has not been used, worn, washed, or altered.
- All original tags, labels, and protective films are attached.
- All accessories, cables, chargers, manuals, and free gifts are included.
- The original packaging (box, inserts, foam) is undamaged and reusable.
- Any bundled promotional item is returned together with the main product.

Items that fail inspection may be refused, returned to you at your cost, or subject to a partial refund of up to 50% of the purchase price.

6. Return Process (Step-by-Step)

6.1 Initiating a Return

- Sign in to your Acme account and navigate to **Account** → **Orders**.
- Locate the order and click “**Return or Replace**” next to the item.
- Select a reason code (e.g., wrong size, changed mind, damaged, defective).
- Choose refund method: original payment, store credit, or exchange.
- Print the prepaid return label (if provided) and the RMA slip.

6.2 Packing & Shipping

- Place the item in its original packaging inside a protective shipping box.
- Include the RMA slip inside the box.
- Attach the prepaid label to the outside of the parcel.
- Drop off at any authorized carrier location within 7 days of RMA issuance.

6.3 Inspection & Approval

Once your return arrives at our warehouse, our team inspects it within **1–2 business days**. You will receive an email confirming approval, partial approval, or rejection with a reason.

6.4 Return Shipping Costs

Reason for Return	Return Shipping Cost	Refund of Original Shipping
Defective / damaged on arrival	Free (prepaid label)	Fully refunded
Wrong item shipped by Acme	Free (prepaid label)	Fully refunded
Changed mind / no longer needed	Customer pays	Not refunded
Wrong size ordered	Customer pays (or free with Plus)	Not refunded
Late return (unauthorized)	Customer pays + \$9.95 fee	Not refunded

7. Refund Methods & Timelines

Refunds are issued to the original payment method unless you explicitly choose store credit. Processing times vary by payment provider:

Payment Method	Refund Destination	Typical Time
Credit / Debit Card	Original card	5–10 business days
PayPal	PayPal balance	3–5 business days
Apple Pay / Google Pay	Linked card / balance	5–10 business days
Bank Transfer	Original bank account	7–14 business days
Gift Card / Store Credit	Acme account credit	Within 24 hours
Cash on Delivery	Bank transfer or store credit	7–14 business days

Note: Refund timing begins from the moment we approve the return, not from the day you shipped it back. Your bank may add additional processing time.

8. Exchanges & Store Credit

Exchanges are available for size, color, or variant differences of the same product, subject to stock availability. If the exchange item is out of stock, you may choose store credit, which is issued instantly and never expires. Store credit:

- Is applied automatically to your Acme account.
- Can be combined with promotional discounts.
- Is non-transferable and cannot be redeemed for cash.
- Is not subject to the 5–10 day bank processing window.

9. Damaged, Defective, or Incorrect Items

If your item arrives damaged, defective, or is not what you ordered, please notify us within **48 hours** of the Delivery Date. Include your order number and clear photos or a short video showing the issue. We will:

- Arrange a prepaid return label at no cost to you.
- Ship a replacement (subject to stock) at no additional shipping charge.
- Or issue a full refund including original shipping.
- For high-value items, arrange a carrier pickup.

10. Late or Missing Refunds

If you have not received your refund within the stated timeframe, please take the following steps:

- Check your bank account or credit card statement again (24–48 hours).
- Contact your bank — posting delays are common.
- Verify the refund wasn't applied as store credit.
- If still unresolved, email refunds@acme-commerce.example with your RMA number.

11. International Returns

Customers outside the United States are responsible for return shipping unless the item arrived defective. Customs duties and import taxes are non-refundable. Please mark the parcel clearly as a “Returned Good” to avoid double taxation. Refunds are issued in USD; currency conversion differences are the customer's responsibility.

12. Restocking Fees

Item Type	Restocking Fee
Standard items in Original Condition	None
Large appliances / furniture	10% of purchase price
Opened electronics	Up to 15%
Items missing accessories or packaging	Up to 25%
Refused deliveries (change of mind)	\$9.95 flat

13. Warranty vs. Return

The 30-day return window is separate from the manufacturer warranty. Defects discovered after the return window should be handled under the applicable warranty. Warranty coverage varies by product and manufacturer; refer to the warranty card in your package or contact support for details.

14. Abuse & Fraud Prevention

Acme reserves the right to refuse returns or refunds, and to close accounts, in cases of:

- Repeat returns exceeding 5 in a 12-month period.
- Returned items that do not match the original purchase (e.g., swapped products).
- Suspicious patterns suggesting drop-shipping, reselling, or fraud.
- Tampered serial numbers, altered labels, or counterfeit items.

15. Dispute Resolution

If you disagree with the outcome of a return decision, you may escalate the matter by emailing disputes@acme-commerce.example within 14 days of the decision. Our resolution team will respond within 5 business days. If unresolved, disputes may be submitted to binding arbitration under the rules described in our Terms of Service.

16. Contact & Appendix

Customer Support: **support@acme-commerce.example**

Refund Team: **refunds@acme-commerce.example**

Phone: +1 (800) 555-0142 (Mon–Fri 9:00–18:00 EST)

Mailing Address: 123 Commerce Way, Suite 400, Wilmington, DE 19801, USA

Appendix A — Reason Codes

Code	Description	Eligible for Prepaid Label?
R01	Changed my mind	No
R02	Wrong size / fit	No (free with Plus)
R03	Item defective	Yes

Code	Description	Eligible for Prepaid Label?
R04	Item damaged in transit	Yes
R05	Received wrong item	Yes
R06	Item not as described	Yes
R07	Late delivery	Contact support
R08	Duplicate order	Yes

This Policy may be updated from time to time. The version in effect on your purchase date governs your return. Material changes will be announced at least 14 days in advance.